

# “If you are a techie, your home page should be GitHub, not Instagram”

**Vinit Shahdeo**, a **software engineer** at **Postman**, has been contributing to many open source projects since his college days. In an exclusive interaction with **Sreejani Bhattacharyya** of **OSFY**, Shahdeo talks about his many contributions to OSS and how newbies starting out can build a career in this domain.



Vinit Shahdeo

Vinit Shahdeo's love for open source began during his college days at Vellore Institute of Technology (VIT). Currently, he works as a software engineer at Postman. He was introduced to GitHub in 2016 when he joined VinnovateIT, an innovation lab at VIT. He found it so interesting that GitHub soon became his home page and he started contributing to open source.

## A range of projects, including one for COVID-19

Shahdeo's first project on GitHub was a basic calculator that computed just the square and cube of a number. He says, "Initially, I used to push my college course projects and a few of the personal projects that I built while learning different Web development skills, onto GitHub. Later, I started maintaining CodeChef's VIT Chapter and the VinnovateIT organisation on GitHub, where we did a few group projects. After that I started contributing to different open source organisations in every possible way."

Shahdeo soon started addressing issues, contributing to the codebase, reviewing others' code, and improving documentation. Today, he spends a lot of time on GitHub. Shahdeo says that he currently maintains a project that is a part of many open source programs

